

Teacher Guide — middle / module-04-doshas

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Overview

Module 4 — Doṣas (Vāta, Pitta, Kapha)

Age band: Middle · **Grades:** 6–8 · **Duration:** 10 sessions × 45 min (≈ 2 weeks)

What this module is

A self-observation framework. Indian classical medicine sorts the body’s functions into three categories — *vāta* (motion), *pitta* (transformation), *kapha* (structure) — and asks students to notice how these three appear in their own daily lives. It is **not** a diagnostic system in this classroom. It is a vocabulary for noticing.

Module 3 introduced *Āyurveda* and named the three *doṣas* briefly. This module does the deeper work: where the *doṣas* come from in the *pañcabhūta* (Module 2), how each one looks in a person’s day, how the day and the year cycle through them, and what “balance” means in practice.

Learning objectives

By the end of this module, students will be able to:

1. **Define** *doṣa*, *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*, *prakṛti*, *vikṛti* in IAST with English meaning.
2. **Map** each *doṣa* to its two constituent *pañcabhūta* — *vāta* = *ākāśa* + *vāyu*, *pitta* = *tejas* + *ap*, *kapha* = *ap* + *pṛthvī*.
3. **Identify** three qualities of each *doṣa* (e.g. *vāta* — dry, cold, mobile) and one observable sign of each in everyday life.
4. **Distinguish** *prakṛti* (constitutional baseline) from *vikṛti* (current state), and explain why the same person can be a *vāta-pitta prakṛti* but have a *kapha vikṛti* during a cold.
5. **Apply** the framework to the daily cycle (*kapha* morning, *pitta* midday, *vāta* evening) and the seasonal cycle.
6. **Critique** the misuse of the framework — over-typing, self-medication, prescriptive labelling — and articulate when to consult a doctor instead.

Connection to other modules

- **From Module 2 (Pañcabhūta).** The five elements combine in pairs to give the three *doṣas*. The module's central diagram is this combination.
- **From Module 3 (Āyurveda).** Module 3 named the three *doṣas*; this module sits inside them in detail.
- **To Module 8 (Yoga).** Many *āsana* recommendations are *doṣa*-aware. Touched in passing in Day 8.
- **To Module 10 (Herbs — separate module).** Herbal recommendations are *doṣa*-aware. Out of scope here.

NEP 2020 alignment

- **§4.6** — Integration of Indian Knowledge Systems into mainstream learning, alongside biology and lifestyle science.
- **§4.23** — Experiential learning: students observe their own bodies and routines as data.
- **§11.8** — Multidisciplinary linkage (biology + Sanskrit + chronobiology + critical thinking).
- **§4.27** — Local context: students notice their family's food and routine patterns.

Prerequisites

- Module 2 (Pañcabhūta) — students should know the five elements and the *guṇa*-accumulation rule.
- Module 3 (Āyurveda) helpful but not required; the relevant scope is restated on Day 1.
- Basic biology of digestion, sleep, and circulation from school science.

Key vocabulary

See `_shared/glossary.md` for full entries.

- *doṣa* — biological functional principle
- *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha* — the three *doṣas*
- *prakṛti*, *vikṛti* — constitutional baseline vs current state
- *ṣaḍ-rasa* — six tastes (light touch on Day 6)
- *agni* — digestive/metabolic fire

Materials checklist (whole module)

- A wall-sized three-column poster of the *tridoṣa* (Sanskrit + English + elements + qualities + signs)
- Index cards (~90) for the qualities-sort activity (Day 4)
- Self-observation worksheet (one per student, used Days 3, 5, 7)
- Six small samples for the six-tastes demo (Day 6) — jaggery (sweet), lemon (sour), salt, pepper (pungent), neem/methi (bitter), unripe banana/black tea (astringent). Check allergies.
- A clock or projector showing the dosha-clock diagram (Day 5)

- Project supplies — poster paper / cardboard / phone for video

Day-by-day overview

Day	Title	Focus	Assessment
1	Where the Doṣas Come From	Bridge from Module 2; the three pairings	—
2	Three Doṣas in Detail	Qualities, sites, functions	Exit ticket
3	Self-Observation: Your Tendencies	<i>prakṛti</i> vs <i>vikṛti</i> ; non-diagnostic	Formative quiz
4	Qualities Sort (activity)	Sort 30 cards by <i>doṣa</i> -quality	Activity rubric
5	The Doṣa Day-Clock	Daily cycle: kapha-morn, pitta-noon, vāta-eve	Formative quiz
6	The Six Tastes & The Doṣas	<i>ṣaḍ-rasa</i> and what calms each <i>doṣa</i>	Reflection
7	Imbalance and When to See a Doctor	Symptoms + safety + scope-limits	Discussion
8	Project Session 1	Design your “doṣa-week” plan	Project draft
9	Project Session 2	Refine, illustrate, rehearse	Project draft
10	Final Assessment + Showcase	Summative quiz + 3-min presentations	Summative + project

Citation sources used

- **Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.57–59** — the canonical definition of the three *doṣas*.
- **Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1.6–7** — Vāgbhaṭa’s compact *doṣa-dhātu-mala* framework.
- See `sources.md` and `.rag-cache/README.md`.

Project brief (one-line teaser)

Each student designs a 5-day “doṣa-aware week” for themselves — sleep times, meals, and one routine activity per day — with one short paragraph explaining which *doṣa* each choice is intended to support. Presented Day 10. Full brief in `assessments/project-brief.md`.

Safety statement (read on Day 1 and again on Day 7)

This module teaches a *framework for noticing*, not a diagnostic system. Nothing in this module should change a student's existing medical care. If a student or family has questions about an actual symptom, the answer is: see a doctor. *Doṣa* talk is wellness-language, not prescription.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 4 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Session title	Lesson file	Activity / assessment
1	Where the Doṣas Come From	days/day-01-bridge.md	Pair-share recall of pañcabhūta
2	Three Doṣas in Detail	days/day-02-three-doshas.md	Exit ticket
3	Self-Observation: Your Tendencies	days/day-03-self-observation.md	quizzes/formative.md Part A
4	Qualities Sort	days/day-04-qualities-sort.md	activities/activity-01-qualities-sort.md
5	The Doṣa Day-Clock	days/day-05-doṣa-clock.md	quizzes/formative.md Part B
6	The Six Tastes & The Doṣas	days/day-06-six-tastes.md	activities/activity-02-taste-station.md
7	Imbalance and When to See a Doctor	days/day-07-imbalance-safety.md	activities/activity-03-scope-debate.md
8	Project Session 1: Plan	days/day-08-project-session-1.md	Project draft submitted
9	Project Session 2: Refine	days/day-09-project-session-2.md	Project draft submitted
10	Final Assessment + Showcase	days/day-10-final-assessment.md	quizzes/summative.md + project

Pacing notes

- Days 1–3 are content-heavy. Day 4's sort activity is the consolidation. If the class needs more time on Days 1–2, swap Day 4 with a recap day and push the sort to Day 5.

- Day 6 (six tastes) is the lightest day; can be compressed if needed to make room for slower learners on Day 3 self-observation.
- Day 7 (safety + scope) is **not optional**. If you only have 6 days, fold it into Day 5.

Suggested running theme

Open each class with: **“What did your body notice yesterday?”** — 2 students share for 30 seconds each. Students need not use *doṣa* vocabulary at first; by Day 5 they will.

Formative vs. summative weight

- Formative quizzes (Days 3 and 5) — diagnostic only, not graded.
- Summative quiz (Day 10) — 25 marks. Combined with project (30 marks) and presentation (5 marks) = 40 total.

What students leave the module with

- A *tridoṣa* table they built themselves, in their notebook.
- An informal sense of their own *prakṛti* tendency — held lightly, not as identity.
- A 5-day “doṣa-aware week” plan they actually wrote.
- The skill to spot when “lifestyle observation” is being misused as “diagnosis.”

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Module 4 Doṣas (Middle)

Posture for this module

Lead with what students can already notice in their own bodies. Some students will think faster, fidget more, dream-wander; some will move slowly, sleep deeply, hold their attention long. These observed tendencies are the data. The *doṣa* framework is one well-developed vocabulary for sorting that data into three buckets. It is **not** a personality test, not a medical diagnosis, and not destiny.

If a student asks “is this real?” — the honest answer is: the framework is a real classical Indian system that practising Ayurvedic clinicians use today. Its claims about *biological-rhythm types* are partly supported by modern chronobiology. Its claims about *biomarker-distinguishable types* are weakly supported and contested. We teach it as a lens for self-observation, not as a science of types.

Common misconceptions to watch for

1. **“I am a Vāta.”** No. Everyone has all three *doṣas*. *Prakṛti* is the *proportion* a person is born with — typically dual-dominant (e.g. *vāta-pitta*) or triple-balanced (rare). Avoid letting students walk away as one-word labels.
2. **“Doṣas are humours like medieval European humours.”** Surface similarity, structural difference. Galenic humours were *fluids* (blood, yellow bile, black bile, phlegm). *Doṣas*

are functional principles — patterns of behaviour in the body, not literal substances. The Senior band explores this; at Middle band a one-line contrast is enough.

3. **“Pitta = anger, Vāta = anxiety, Kapha = laziness.”** Pop simplifications. The *doṣas* are physiological first. The emotional layer is a downstream correlation, not the definition.
4. **“Doṣas decide what you should eat.”** Only loosely. Modern nutritional needs (protein, micronutrients, calories) come first. *Doṣa*-aware adjustment is a small overlay, not a substitute.
5. **Confusing *prakṛti* (Ayurveda) with *prakṛti* (Sāṅkhya).** Same Sanskrit word, different referent. In Sāṅkhya, *prakṛti* is the universal substance from which everything emerges. In Ayurveda — what we use in this module — *prakṛti* is *your* individual constitutional baseline. Mention the dual use once and move on.

On Sanskrit pronunciation

Drill these in week 1:

- *vāta* — “VAH-tuh” (long ā)
- *pitta* — “PIT-tuh” (geminate t)
- *kapha* — “KUH-pha” (aspirated ph — like “uphill,” not English “f”)
- *prakṛti* — “PRUH-kri-ti” (vowel ṛ rolled lightly)
- *vikṛti* — “VI-kri-ti”
- *doṣa* — “DOE-shuh”

Common error: students will say “PITTA” with hard English t, like “pizza.” The correct sound is closer to the t in Italian *spaghetti*.

Safety scope (CRITICAL — read before Day 7)

This module trains the framework, not its clinical application. Specifically:

- **No herbal recommendations.** If a student asks “what should I take for X?”, redirect: “that’s a doctor’s job, not ours.”
- **No self-diagnosis.** Even the self-observation worksheet (Day 3) is framed as “tendency” not “type.”
- **Existing care.** A student already on prescribed medication should change *nothing* based on this module.
- **Mental health.** Don’t let “Vāta imbalance” become a euphemism for anxiety that a student needs help with. Refer to school counsellor.

On the modern-science framing

The closest robust modern parallel to the *doṣa* day-clock (Day 5) is **chronobiology** — the science of circadian and ultradian rhythms in metabolism, alertness, hormone release. Cite Roenneberg’s *chronotype* work if you want a name. The looser correlate is *somatotype* (Sheldon’s ectomorph / mesomorph / endomorph), but Sheldon’s work has serious methodological problems and shouldn’t be used as a defence of *doṣa* typology. Better not to mention Sheldon at all.

The Prasher et al. (2008) genome-expression study is occasionally cited by Ayurveda-defenders. It found modest differences in self-identified *vāta/pitta/kapha* types. Replication has been mixed. At Middle band, this is too inside-baseball — leave it to Senior.

Differentiation hints

- **Tier up (fast finishers):** Have them research one modern study on chronobiology and explain the parallel — or critique it — in one paragraph.
- **Tier down (scaffolding):** Reduce vocabulary to three terms: *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*. Drop *prakṛti/vikṛti* until Day 4.

Sensitivity notes

- Some students come from families that already use *doṣa* talk casually (“don’t eat that, it’ll raise your pitta”). Honour this without privileging it. The class frame is: we’re learning the framework carefully.
- A student with a chronic condition (asthma, diabetes, ADHD, depression) may feel exposed by the self-observation worksheet. Allow opt-out without explanation. Don’t make the worksheet collection public.
- Body-image concerns: *kapha* is often described with words like “heavy” and “stable build.” For students who already feel self-conscious about weight, be careful to frame *kapha* as a *strength* (stamina, immunity, calm) — which the classical texts do too.

Project oversight (Days 8–10)

- Confirm pairs/individual by end of Day 5.
- Day 8: every student leaves with a *5-day plan outline* and at least one *doṣa* the plan is targeting.
- Day 9: every student leaves with a *complete* (if rough) plan and the chosen presentation format.
- Day 10: 3-minute presentations, strict timer.

Assessment grading sequence

1. Day 3 formative quiz — mark within 24 hours; identify students needing scaffolding.
2. Day 5 formative quiz — same.
3. Day 10 summative — mark over the weekend. Combine with project rubric for final grade.

If you only have 6 days, not 10

Compressed day	Was day(s)
1	1 (bridge)
2	2 (three <i>doṣas</i>) + 3 (self-observation) compressed
3	4 (qualities sort)
4	5 (clock) + 7 (safety) compressed — do not drop safety

Compressed day	Was day(s)
5	8 + 9 (project) collapsed into one period
6	10 (summative + showcase)

Drop Day 6 (six tastes) in a compressed run. Skip Day 4 only if you must.

Sources

Sources — Module 4 Doṣas (Middle)

Primary classical sources

The two anchor texts for this module are the *Caraka Saṁhitā* and the *Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya*. Verse numbering below follows the editions in standard use in Indian Ayurvedic colleges.

Citation	Used in	Content
Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.57	Day 2, Day 7	The three <i>doṣas</i> — <i>vāta</i> , <i>pitta</i> , <i>śleṣman</i> (= <i>kapha</i>) — when in their natural state sustain the body; when vitiated, they cause harm. This is the source-of-record statement of the framework.
Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.58	Day 2 (paraphrase)	Doṣa-dhātu-mala enumeration: three <i>doṣas</i> , seven <i>dhātus</i> (tissues), three <i>malas</i> (wastes) constitute the <i>śarīra</i> (body).
Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.59	Day 2 anchor paraphrase	<i>vāyuh pittaṁ kaphaścoktaḥ śārīro doṣasaṅgrahaḥ</i> — “Vāyu, pitta, and kapha — declared the summary of bodily <i>doṣas</i> .” Used as the Middle-band paraphrase citation.
Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1.6–7	Day 5	Vāgbhaṭa’s compact formulation of the <i>doṣa-dhātu-mala</i> triad and the principle that the <i>doṣas</i> have characteristic times of day, season, and life-stage.
Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna	Day 7	The principle that knowing

Citation	Used in	Content
1.8		the <i>doṣas</i> in natural and vitiated states is the basis of medical science.

Modern science references (Day 5 and Day 7)

Standard middle-school biology and chronobiology references are sufficient. None of the references below are required student reading.

- **Chronobiology of digestion** — Panda, S. et al. (2012). “Time-restricted feeding without reducing caloric intake prevents metabolic diseases in mice fed a high-fat diet.” *Cell Metabolism* 15. (For Day 5 — the modern observation that meal timing matters, independent of calories.)
- **Chronotypes (morningness/eveningness)** — Roenneberg, T. (2012). *Internal Time: Chronotypes, Social Jet Lag, and Why You’re So Tired*. Harvard University Press. (Used as a modern parallel to *doṣa*-clock framing.)
- **Six tastes and modern dietetics** — Mooventhana, A. and Nivethitha, L. (2017). “Scientific evidence-based effects of hydrotherapy on various systems of the body.” (Tangential — used only as a flag that some lifestyle claims are modestly supported by modern trials.)

Why we don’t quote certain commentators

This module avoids citation of the *Aṣṭāṅga Saṅgraha* (Vṛddha-Vāgbhaṭa) and Cakrapāṇi’s commentary on Caraka because verse-numbering across editions varies more than the two anchor texts. The Middle band needs traceable citations.

What students see vs what teachers see

- **Students** see the paraphrase “the three *doṣas* — *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha* — in their balanced state sustain the body; vitiated, they cause disease” with the reference “Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.57.”
- **Teachers** have access to the full reference table and the `.rag-cache/README.md` build note.

Note on transliteration

We use IAST throughout: *vāta* (not *vata*), *pitta*, *kapha*, *śleṣman* (the classical synonym for *kapha*), *prakṛti* (not *prakriti*), *vikṛti*. Where popular spellings differ, the glossary lists the common alternatives.

Day 1 — Where the Doṣas Come From

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students recall the five *pañcabhūta*, pair them into three combinations, and articulate why the body might be organised around motion, transformation, and structure.

Materials

- Whiteboard with the *pañcabhūta* diagram from Module 2 (or a printed copy)
- A small fan, a candle (unlit, for show), a stone, a glass of water, an empty box
- One blank page per student to start the *doṣa* notebook

Vocabulary introduced today

- *doṣa* (IAST: *doṣa*; lit. “that which can become faulty / humour”) — a biological functional principle in Ayurveda. In its natural state, it sustains the body; out of balance, it causes harm.
- *tridoṣa* (IAST: *tri-doṣa*; lit. “three doṣas”) — the three together: *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- On the board: “Name the five elements in IAST.” Whole-class chorus.
- “What did *pr̥thvī* mean again? *Ap*? *Tejas*? *Vāyu*? *Ākāśa*?”
- “Today we ask: what happens when you combine two of them at a time? Why might the body be built that way?”

Core (20 min)

1. **Recall the five elements with the props.** Hold each up briefly:
 - stone → *pr̥thvī* (solid)
 - water glass → *ap* (liquid)
 - candle → *tejas* (heat/light)
 - fan → *vāyu* (air, moving)
 - empty box → *ākāśa* (space inside)
2. **The shift from Module 2.** Module 2 asked “what categories does *matter* come in?” Today we ask: “What categories do *bodily functions* come in?” The body is not made of *just matter* — it does things. It moves. It transforms food. It holds itself together.
3. **Three categories of doing — build on the board:**

What the body does	Need this kind of element	Pair
Moves things — breath, blood, food through gut, signals to muscles	Something that moves freely, in a space	<i>ākāśa</i> + <i>vāyu</i>
Transforms things — digestion (food → energy), seeing (light →	Something that converts, with a medium	<i>tejas</i> + <i>ap</i>

What the body does	Need this kind of element	Pair
image), body heat		
Holds things together — bones, muscle, skin, fluids that lubricate	Something solid and cohesive	<i>ap + pṛthvī</i>

4. **Name the three pairs:**

Pair	Sanskrit name	Lit. meaning
<i>ākāśa + vāyu</i>	vāta	“wind, that-which-moves”
<i>tejas + ap</i>	pitta	“that which heats / digests”
<i>ap + pṛthvī</i>	kapha	“phlegm, that-which-holds”

5. **The Sanskrit name for the trio.** Write it: **tridoṣa**. “Three doṣas.” In classical Indian medicine, these three functional principles are how the body is organised.
6. **Source-of-record paraphrase.** “*The Caraka Saṁhitā — one of the founding Ayurveda texts, c. 1st millennium BCE/CE — says: when vāta, pitta, and kapha are in their natural state, they sustain the body; when they are out of balance, they cause disease.*” (Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.57 — paraphrase.)
7. **What this module is not.** Read aloud the safety statement from the README: this is a vocabulary for noticing, not a diagnosis system.

Activity (15 min) — Build your tridoṣa page

- Open notebook to a fresh page. At the top, write: **tridoṣa — three doṣa**.
- Draw three columns, one per doṣa. At the top of each column write the Sanskrit name + IAST + literal meaning.
- Below each name, draw the two elements that combine. Use the Module 2 element-symbol you made earlier.
- Leave the rest of the column blank — you’ll fill it tomorrow.
- Partner check: swap notebooks with the person next to you. Read theirs out loud. Catch one mistake if you can.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-question exit: “Which of the three feels most like YOU right now? Don’t think hard — just one word.” Sticky note.
- Preview: “Tomorrow we fill in the rest of the columns — what each doṣa actually does in your body.”

Student-facing content

Three categories of doing:

Doṣa	Sanskrit	Elements	What it does
<i>vāta</i>	“wind”	<i>ākāśa + vāyu</i>	moves things
<i>pitta</i>	“heater”	<i>tejas + ap</i>	transforms things
<i>kapha</i>	“binder”	<i>ap + pṛthvī</i>	holds things

When they are in balance, they sustain the body. When they are out of balance, they cause trouble.

— Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.57 (paraphrase)

Homework

- Look around your home tonight. Find **one example** for each of the three: something that *moves*, something that *transforms*, something that *holds together*. Write the three examples in your notebook.

Differentiation

- One tier up:** Why does *ap* (water) appear in TWO of the three doṣas? What does that suggest about water’s special role in the framework?
- One tier down:** Just remember the three names and what each does. The element pairing can come tomorrow.

Teacher notes

- The trickiest pairing is *kapha* = *ap* + *pṛthvī*. Students will want *pṛthvī* alone — but the classical formulation is that earth needs water to hold its cohesive structure (think: dry sand vs wet sand).
- Some students will ask why fire (*tejas*) doesn’t appear alone. Good question. The classical answer: fire by itself doesn’t transform — it needs something fluid to transform *in*. Hence *tejas + ap = pitta*.
- Don’t go deep on *prakṛti/vikṛti* today. That’s Day 3.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.57 (paraphrase; see `sources.md` for full reference).

Day 2 — Three Doṣas in Detail

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students name three qualities of each *doṣa*, one main bodily site, and one observable everyday sign of each, and explain why those qualities follow logically from the element pairing.

Materials

- The class *tridoṣa* poster (large, on the wall)

- Whiteboard for the qualities table
- Exit-ticket slips

Vocabulary introduced today

- *guṇa* (IAST: guṇa; lit. “quality, attribute”) — a property of a substance or process. We met *guṇa* lightly in Module 2; in Ayurveda, each *doṣa* is identified by a set of *guṇas*.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Recall: “*What are the three doṣas, and what does each one do?*” Whole-class chorus.
- “*Today: what does each one actually feel like?*”

Core (25 min)

1. **From elements to qualities — derive on the board.** Don’t just give the answer; ask students to predict.

“*If vāta is space + air — what is wind like? What is space like?*” Take answers. Steer toward:

- dry (air dries skin and laundry)
- cold (a breeze cools you)
- mobile (air moves)
- light (air rises)
- rough (a dry wind is harsh on skin)
- subtle (you don’t see air; you feel it)

“*If pitta is fire + a little water — what is fire like?*”

- hot
- sharp / penetrating (fire cuts through)
- light (flame rises)
- oily / slightly liquid (the water in pitta gives it fluidity)
- sour-smelling (sweat, indigestion)

“*If kapha is water + earth — what is wet earth like?*”

- heavy (wet earth is heavy)
- slow (mud moves slowly)
- cold (cool to touch)
- oily / smooth (wet clay is smooth)
- stable (wet earth packs together)
- dense

2. **Build the canonical table** (students copy into notebooks):

Doṣa	Elements	Three key qualities	Main site in body	One everyday sign
<i>vāta</i>	<i>ākāśa</i> + <i>vāyu</i>	dry, cold, mobile	colon, lower body	dry skin, fast speech, fidget
<i>pitta</i>	<i>tejas</i> + <i>ap</i>	hot, sharp, oily	small intestine, eyes	strong appetite, sharp focus, sweating
<i>kapha</i> <i>a</i>	<i>ap</i> + <i>prthvī</i>	heavy, slow, cool	stomach, chest	steady stamina, heavy sleeper, slow morning

3. **What balance means.** A balanced *doṣa* state is what the body needs to do its job. *Vāta* in balance is *graceful movement*. Out of balance, it is *jittery, jumpy, anxious*. *Pitta* in balance is *clear thinking and strong digestion*. Out of balance, it is *burning gut, sharp irritability*. *Kapha* in balance is *steady stamina and strong immunity*. Out of balance, it is *sluggish, congested, heavy*.

4. **The source paraphrase** (write on the board for students to copy):

“Vāyu, pitta, and kapha — these are declared the summary of the body’s *doṣas*.” — Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.59 (paraphrase)

The Sanskrit *pratīka* (cue-phrase) is *vāyuh pittaṁ kaphaścoktaḥ* — “vāyu, pitta, and kapha — declared...” Read it aloud once. Students don’t need to memorise the Sanskrit; the *paraphrase* is enough.

5. **Modern parallel — one line each, no deep dive.**

- The *doṣas* do not correspond to modern molecules or organs cleanly. They are *functional categories*.
- The closest modern parallel is **chronobiology** — the study of how the body’s activities cycle through the day. We’ll meet this on Day 5.

Activity (10 min) — Three signs hunt

- Working in pairs. On a half-sheet, head three columns: *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*.
- In each column, write *one observable sign* of that *doṣa* from someone you know (not yourself). One line each.
- Examples to seed the activity:
 - “My uncle eats fast and gets very hungry — pitta sign.”
 - “My grandmother walks slowly and sleeps deeply — kapha sign.”
 - “My friend talks fast and can’t sit still — vāta sign.”
- **Important** — they are *signs* or *tendencies*, not diagnoses. We’re noticing patterns, not labelling people.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Exit ticket** (1 question, 2 min): “In one sentence — what is one quality of each *doṣa*? Use the words on the board.”
- Collect.
- Preview Day 3: “Tomorrow — your own tendencies. Carefully.”

Student-facing content

The three *doṣas* in summary:

Doṣa	Lit.	Elements	Qualities	What you might notice
<i>vāta</i>	“wind”	space + air	dry, cold, mobile, light, rough	fast speech, fidget, dry skin, light sleeper
<i>pitta</i>	“heater”	fire + water	hot, sharp, oily, light	strong appetite, focused, sweats, gets irritable when hungry
<i>kapha</i>	“binder”	water + earth	heavy, slow, cool, oily, stable	calm, steady, deep sleeper, slow to anger, holds weight easily

When in balance, each *doṣa* sustains the body. When out of balance, each causes its own kind of trouble.

— *paraphrased from Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.59*

Homework

- Tonight, observe ONE person in your home for 10 minutes (gently — don’t stare). Write one sentence about which *doṣa* their daily pattern reminds you of, and why. (Do **not** tell them.)

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Look up “biological clock” in any biology resource. Write one sentence connecting it to the *doṣa* idea. (We’ll formalise this on Day 5.)
- **One tier down:** Memorise the three names and one quality each: *vāta* dry, *pitta* hot, *kapha* heavy.

Teacher notes

- Don’t let students start labelling each other publicly. The home observation is *private* writing.
- Some students will see themselves as “obviously *vāta*” because they’re fidgety today. Note: today’s state ≠ baseline. Save this distinction for Day 3.
- The geminate *t* in *pitta* is tricky. Drill it: PIT-tuh, not PIH-tuh.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1.59 (paraphrase). See `sources.md`.

Day 3 — Self-Observation: Your Tendencies

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students explain the distinction between *prakṛti* (constitutional baseline) and *vikṛti* (current state), complete a non-diagnostic self-observation worksheet, and articulate why the framework should be held lightly.

Materials

- Printed self-observation worksheet (one per student)
- The Caraka safety paraphrase on a slide or the board
- Sticky notes for the exit reflection

Vocabulary introduced today

- *prakṛti* (IAST: pra-kṛti; lit. “nature, primary disposition”) — in Ayurveda, the constitutional baseline you are born with: a particular *proportion* of *vāta* : *pitta* : *kapha*.
- *vikṛti* (IAST: vi-kṛti; lit. “deviation, modification”) — your *current* state. Can drift from *prakṛti* due to season, food, stress, sleep.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily prompt: “*What did your body notice yesterday?*” — 2 students share.
- “*Yesterday we learned the three doṣas in detail. Today we ask: which one tends to be loudest in you? Carefully.*”

Core (15 min)

1. The *prakṛti* vs *vikṛti* distinction — write the analogy on the board.

Think of yourself like a song. *Prakṛti* is the **key** — the underlying note your life is set in. *Vikṛti* is **today’s notes** — what you’re actually playing right now. The same song can be played calmly or frantically. The key doesn’t change. The notes do.

2. Two things this distinction does:

- It prevents the “I AM *vāta*” trap. You’re not a *doṣa*. You have a *tendency*.
- It explains why “you have a cold today” doesn’t change your constitution — it changes your *vikṛti*.

3. Most people are dual-dominant. Pure single-*doṣa prakṛti* is rare. Most people are *vāta-pitta*, *pitta-kapha*, or *vāta-kapha*. A few are roughly balanced across all three (*sama-prakṛti* — rarest).

4. Source paraphrase. “*Classical Ayurveda holds that prakṛti is set at conception by the relative balance of the doṣas at that time, with influences from the mother’s diet and lifestyle during pregnancy.*” (Paraphrased from Caraka Saṁhitā, Vimānasthāna 8 — discussed in fuller detail at Senior band.)

5. The safety statement (read aloud, every student copies into notebook):

This worksheet is for noticing, not diagnosis. I am not “a Vāta” or “a Pitta.” I have tendencies. If I have a medical concern, I will see a doctor — not my notebook.

Activity (20 min) — Self-observation worksheet

Hand out the worksheet (template below). Students fill it in privately. They are **not** asked to share the results.

Worksheet

My doṣa tendencies — a *non-diagnostic* self-observation

For each row, tick the column that best matches your usual self over the past month. There are no right answers. Be honest, not aspirational.

#	Question	Vāta	Pitta	Kapha
1	Build	thin, hard to gain weight	medium, athletic	solid, gains weight easily
2	Skin in winter	dry, cracks	sensitive, can flush	smooth, oily, cool
3	Energy through the day	bursty: high then low	steady-strong	slow-warm-up, long-lasting
4	Speech	fast, jumpy	clear, sharp	slow, measured
5	Appetite	irregular, sometimes forget meals	strong, must-eat-on-time	mild, can skip a meal easily
6	Sleep	light, dreams a lot	sound, ~7 hours, vivid dreams	deep, ~8+ hours, slow to wake
7	When stressed	worried, can't settle	irritable, sharp-tongued	withdraw, eat or sleep
8	Hands	cold, sometimes dry	warm, sometimes moist	cool, sometimes oily
9	Movement	quick, restless	brisk, purposeful	steady, slow to start
10	Memory	quick to learn, quick to forget	sharp; remembers facts	slow to learn, never forgets

Total ticks per column: Vāta ____ Pitta ____ Kapha ____

My tentative *tendency* (not type!) is: _____

Important. No question has a “wrong” answer. Most people score across all three. The top column is your *current tendency* — which may or may not be your *prakṛti*.

Reminder: if I have a medical concern, I see a doctor — not this worksheet.

After completion (10 min), discussion (10 min):

- “Show of hands — who came out roughly balanced across two of the three?” Most.

- “Who came out heavily one-sided?” Some.
- “Now the important question — does today’s tendency match your usual? Or are you currently in a *vikṛti* state — recently slept poorly, eaten different food, exam stress?”

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Formative quiz on a slip of paper (5 questions, 3 min)** — see quizzes/formative.md Part A.
- Collect.
- Preview Day 4: “Tomorrow — sort 30 qualities into three buckets in a hands-on game.”

Student-facing content

Two important words:

- ***prakṛti*** = your baseline — the proportion of *vāta* : *pitta* : *kapha* you are born with.
- ***vikṛti*** = your current state — which can drift due to season, food, stress, sleep.

If you scored high on a column on the worksheet today, that’s your *current tendency*. It may or may not be your *prakṛti*. People shift around. That’s normal.

You are not a doṣa. You have a tendency. The framework is a lens, not a label.

Homework

- Keep the worksheet in your notebook. Tonight, redo it in your head AS IF it were yesterday morning. Did your top column shift? Note in one line.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Try the worksheet from your most calm week of the year vs your most stressed week. Compare. What does that tell you about *prakṛti* vs *vikṛti*?
- **One tier down:** Just complete the worksheet. The *prakṛti/vikṛti* distinction can be revisited on Day 5.

Teacher notes

- This is the most ethically sensitive day in the module. Watch for:
 - Students writing “I am Vāta” or “I am stupid because Kapha is slow” — interrupt these gently.
 - Students who score heavily on one column and seem distressed — pull aside privately.
 - Students who refuse to complete the worksheet — accept, no questions asked.
- **Do NOT collect or grade** the worksheets. They stay in the student’s notebook, private.
- The formative quiz is on the *framework concepts* — not on the worksheet’s content.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Caraka Saṁhitā, *Vimānasthāna* 8 (paraphrase on *prakṛti* determination). The full classical determination criteria are discussed at Senior band; here we paraphrase one principle.

Day 4 — Qualities Sort

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students sort 30 qualities/objects/events into the three *doṣa* buckets with reasoned justification, defending borderline cases.

Materials

- 30 prepared cards (one quality, food, or event per card — see activity file)
- 3 paper trays / circles on the floor, each labelled with one *doṣa*
- Worksheet for the borderline-cases reflection (last 10 min)

Vocabulary refreshed

- *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*, *guṇa*, *prakṛti*, *vikṛti* — no new vocabulary today; this is consolidation.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Whole-class chorus: name the three *doṣas* + one quality of each.
- “Today is the day we get fast at this. Cards, trays, 25 minutes. Go.”

Activity (25 min) — Qualities sort

Full activity in `activities/activity-01-qualities-sort.md`. Summary:

- 3 trays on the floor labelled *vāta*, *pitta*, *kapha*.
- 30 cards in a deck. Each card has a single phrase: “ice cream,” “running,” “dry wind,” “stew,” “shouting in anger,” “deep sleep,” etc.
- Class works in pairs. Each pair draws 6 cards in turn. They place each card on a tray and write a 1-line *why* in their notebook.
- After 15 min, swap pairs. Each pair reads aloud one card placement that’s *not obvious* and defends it. Other pairs can disagree.
- The teacher keeps a tally on the board of cards where pairs disagreed.

Core debrief (10 min)

1. **Which cards were tricky?** Discuss the top 3 disagreed-on cards.
2. **The framework’s limits.** Some objects are *multiple* — a hot chocolate is *pitta* (hot) AND *kapha* (heavy, milky, sweet). That’s fine. The framework doesn’t claim a clean one-to-one match. Most real things are mixes.
3. **The *guṇa* principle** (state the rule):

Like increases like. To *balance* a *doṣa*, use the *opposite* quality.

Examples:

- *Vāta* (dry, cold) is increased by dry crackers and cold weather. Calmed by warm soup and oil massage.
- *Pitta* (hot, sharp) is increased by spicy food and arguments. Calmed by cool milk and a walk in shade.
- *Kapha* (heavy, slow) is increased by heavy oily meals and naps. Calmed by brisk walking and light food.

This is the *guṇa* principle the rest of Ayurveda is built on.

4. **What this is NOT.** It is **not** a prescription for what *you* should eat. Modern nutrition still applies (protein, vitamins, calories). *Doṣa*-aware adjustment is a small overlay on top.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-word exit: “Which *doṣa* do you think you’ve been most around this week — in the room you’re in most, the food you’ve eaten most, the weather?” Sticky note.
- Preview Day 5: “Tomorrow — the day-clock. Which *doṣa* runs when.”

Student-facing content

The *guṇa* principle: like increases like.

If you want to *increase* a *doṣa*, use its qualities. If you want to *calm* a *doṣa*, use the *opposite* qualities.

Doṣa	Qualities	Calmed by
<i>vāta</i>	dry, cold, mobile	warm, moist, steady — warm soup, oil, rest
<i>pitta</i>	hot, sharp, oily	cool, mild, sweet — milk, coriander, walk in shade
<i>kapha</i>	heavy, slow, cool	light, dry, warm — ginger tea, brisk walk

Reminder: these are observations about *qualities of things*, not prescriptions for *what you should eat*. Modern nutrition still applies.

Homework

- Write down what you ate at dinner tonight. One line per item describing the *qualities* (heavy/light, hot/cold, dry/oily). Don’t worry about which *doṣa* — just the qualities.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Take your dinner from homework and write which *doṣa* each item is likely to increase. Then ask: did your meal *balance* you, or push you one way?
- **One tier down:** Focus on three cards: ice cream (*kapha*), chili (*pitta*), windy day (*vāta*). Just those three patterns.

Teacher notes

- The sort activity is high-energy. Set a timer.
- Some pairs will park easy cards quickly and avoid the hard ones. Walk around and hand them a hard one (“here — try this”).
- For cards with genuine ambiguity (e.g. “fresh fruit”), the right answer is “it depends on which fruit, when, and how.” Don’t force a single placement; let the discussion be the lesson.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Concepts only — no direct citation in this lesson. The *guṇa* principle “like increases like” is stated across Caraka, Suśruta, and Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya; full citations in `sources.md`.

Day 5 — The Doṣa Day-Clock

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students name the six 4-hour windows of the *doṣa* day-clock with their dominant *doṣa*, explain *why* each *doṣa* dominates at that time, and connect this to one modern observation about circadian biology.

Materials

- Large clock-face diagram on the board, divided into 6 four-hour windows
- Coloured chalk / markers (one per *doṣa*)
- Printed copy of the day-clock for each student

Vocabulary introduced today

- *kāla* (IAST: *kāla*; lit. “time”) — used in Ayurveda as “the time-of-day factor” in determining how the *doṣas* behave.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- “At what time of day do you feel most alert?” — quick show of hands.
- “At what time do you feel most slow / sleepy?”
- “Today we ask: is this random, or is there a pattern?”

Core (20 min)

1. **Build the clock on the board.** Draw a 24-hour clock face. Divide into six 4-hour wedges. Label each with start-end time. Then assign each window its dominant *doṣa* (colour-coded):

Window	Time	Dominant doṣa	Why
1	6 am – 10 am	<i>kapha</i>	Body is heavy, slow to start — heavy mucus, deep tissue. Best for solid breakfast, mild exercise.
2	10 am – 2 pm	<i>pitta</i>	Digestive fire peaks at noon. Best for the main meal of the day.
3	2 pm – 6 pm	<i>vāta</i>	Energy is bursty, mind active, body lighter. Best for focused work, short snacks.
4	6 pm – 10 pm	<i>kapha</i>	Body slows for sleep. Best for light dinner, calming activity.
5	10 pm – 2 am	<i>pitta</i>	Body's deep repair (liver, metabolism). Best for actual sleep — don't snack now.

Window	Time	Dominant doṣa	Why
6	2 am – 6 am	vāta	Light sleep, dreams; body cycles toward waking. Wake at end of window.

“Each doṣa shows up twice — once during the day, once at night.”

2. **The classical principle.** Source paraphrase:

“The doṣas have their own times — kapha in the morning and early night, pitta at midday and midnight, vāta in the afternoon and pre-dawn.” — paraphrased from Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1 (Vāgbhaṭa)

3. **Why this matters in practice (Ayurveda’s claim):**

- Heavy meal at *kapha* time (6–10 pm) sits heavy and disrupts sleep.
- Heavy meal at *pitta* time (10 am – 2 pm) digests well.
- Trying to sleep deeply at *vāta* time (2–6 am) is hard — that’s why you wake at 4 am even if you went to bed late.
- Skipping the *kapha* morning window (sleeping in until 11 am) leaves you groggy — the body needed to wake before the kapha window closed.

4. **The modern parallel — chronobiology** (state, don’t overstate):

- Modern science: the body has a **circadian rhythm** controlled by the suprachiasmatic nucleus in the brain, driven by light exposure.
- Insulin sensitivity (how well you handle sugar): higher in the morning, lower at night. Big dinner late = worse glucose handling. (Real effect; see Panda 2012.)
- Cortisol (stress hormone): peaks ~6–8 am, drops through the day. That’s why morning is mentally “harder to start” if you slept badly.
- Body temperature: lowest around 4–5 am, peaks late afternoon. Matches *vāta* time roughly.

The honest framing: the *general principle* (the body cycles through the day) is robust modern science. The *specific doṣa-clock windows* are an Ayurvedic codification — not a 1:1 match with modern timing studies, but a workable approximation.

Activity (15 min) — Map your day

- Hand out the printed day-clock.
- Students annotate it with what they actually do at each window. (Wake 6:30, brush teeth, breakfast 7:30, school 8:30, lunch 12:30, etc.)
- For each entry, ask: “Is this activity matched to the dominant doṣa at this time?”

- Heavy lunch at noon (pitta time) — matched.
- Heavy dinner at 9 pm (kapha time) — mismatched.
- Heavy nap at 3 pm (vāta time) — mismatched.
- Each student picks ONE mismatch and writes a one-line *what would I change?*

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Formative quiz, Part B** (5 questions, 4 min) — see quizzes/formative.md Part B.
- Collect.
- Preview Day 6: “Tomorrow — the six tastes. Yes, we will taste things.”

Student-facing content

The doṣa day-clock:

Window	Time	Doṣa	Best for
1	6 am – 10 am	<i>kapha</i>	wake, light exercise, solid breakfast
2	10 am – 2 pm	<i>pitta</i>	main meal of the day, focused work
3	2 pm – 6 pm	<i>vāta</i>	quick work, short snacks
4	6 pm – 10 pm	<i>kapha</i>	light dinner, wind down
5	10 pm – 2 am	<i>pitta</i>	deep sleep (body’s repair)
6	2 am – 6 am	<i>vāta</i>	wake at the end of this window

The principle: align activities with the dominant doṣa of the time.

— *paraphrased from Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1*

Modern parallel: chronobiology. The body has rhythms. Insulin works better in the morning. Cortisol peaks at dawn. Body temperature peaks late afternoon. The general shape matches; the exact timing doesn’t precisely line up. Both frameworks point to the same underlying observation: *when* matters as much as *what*.

Homework

- Tonight, note your bedtime. Tomorrow morning, note your wake time. Then write: which doṣa-window did each fall into? Was your sleep aligned with the recommended pattern?

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Look up “circadian rhythm” and write one sentence on the mechanism (light → SCN → melatonin/cortisol). How does the modern picture differ from the *doṣa*-clock?
- **One tier down:** Memorise just the three midday/midnight windows: 10–2 (day) and 10–2 (night) — both pitta. That’s the spine of the clock.

Teacher notes

- Some students will say their family’s dinner is at 9 pm. Don’t shame them. Note the principle; don’t prescribe.
- The clock is an *idealised pattern*, not a rigid rule. Indian families dinner at all sorts of times for legitimate reasons. The point is to notice the *trade-off*, not to comply.
- Don’t conflate the *doṣa* clock with the modern circadian rhythm too tightly. They overlap in spirit, not in detail.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1 (Vāgbhaṭa) — paraphrase on *doṣa* times of day. See [sources.md](#).
- Modern parallel: Panda et al. (2012) on meal-timing and glucose handling — teacher reference only; not student-facing citation.

Day 6 — The Six Tastes & The Doṣas

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students name the *ṣaḍ-rasa* (six tastes) in IAST with English meaning, identify which tastes calm and which aggravate each *doṣa*, and articulate why food is a primary lever in Ayurvedic balance.

Materials

- Six small samples (covered before the lesson starts):
 - Sweet (*madhura*) — jaggery / a piece of date
 - Sour (*amla*) — lemon wedge / amla powder
 - Salty (*lavaṇa*) — rock salt
 - Pungent (*kaṭu*) — fresh ginger / a peppercorn
 - Bitter (*tikta*) — methi leaf / a tiny bit of neem powder
 - Astringent (*kaṣāya*) — unripe banana / strong black tea
- 6 paper plates / labelled cups
- Toothpicks for sampling
- A glass of water per student for rinsing

- Allergy/dietary check completed in advance

Vocabulary introduced today

- *ṣaḍ-rasa* (IAST: ṣaḍ-rasa; lit. “six tastes”) — the Ayurvedic taste classification.
- *madhura*, *amla*, *lavaṇa*, *kaṭu*, *tikta*, *kaṣāya* (sweet, sour, salty, pungent, bitter, astringent) — the six tastes.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- “How many tastes are there?” Take answers. Most students will say 5 (sweet, sour, salty, bitter, umami). Some will say 4.
- “Ayurveda counts six. The extras — pungent and astringent — are textural-chemical, not strictly the same as the modern taste-receptor 5.”

Core (15 min)

1. The six tastes — build the table on the board:

Sanskrit	English	Example	Elements that dominate	Increases	Calms
<i>madhura</i>	sweet	sugar, ghee, rice, milk	earth + water	<i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i> , <i>pitta</i>
<i>amla</i>	sour	lemon, yoghurt, vinegar	earth + fire	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i>
<i>lavaṇa</i>	salty	rock salt, sea salt	water + fire	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i>
<i>kaṭu</i>	pungent	chili, ginger, pepper, garlic	fire + air	<i>pitta</i> , <i>vāta</i>	<i>kapha</i>
<i>tikta</i>	bitter	neem, turmeric, methi, dark chocolate	air + space	<i>vāta</i>	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>
<i>kaṣāya</i>	astringent	unripe banana, pomegranate, black tea	air + earth	<i>vāta</i>	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>

“Notice the pattern. Each taste calms exactly two doṣas and aggravates one or two.”

2. The rule of thumb (state simply):

- *Vāta* is calmed by **sweet, sour, salty** — warm, oily, grounding foods. Aggravated by bitter, astringent, pungent.
 - *Pitta* is calmed by **sweet, bitter, astringent** — cool, mild foods. Aggravated by sour, salty, pungent.
 - *Kapha* is calmed by **pungent, bitter, astringent** — light, dry, warm foods. Aggravated by sweet, sour, salty.
3. **A balanced meal includes all six.** This is the classical recommendation — a proper meal touches all six tastes, in proportions adjusted to the eater’s *prakṛti* and the season.
 4. **A modern note.** Modern nutrition focuses on macronutrients (protein, fat, carbs) and micronutrients (vitamins, minerals). Ayurveda’s *six tastes* is a *qualitative* sorting that pre-dates that vocabulary. Both can be true at once: a balanced meal needs both macro coverage AND qualitative variety.

Activity (20 min) — Taste station rotation

Detailed protocol in `activities/activity-02-taste-station.md`. Summary:

- Six small stations around the room. Each has the sample, a label, and a worksheet question.
- Students rotate in pairs. 2 minutes per station.
- At each station: taste a small sample. Write (a) the IAST + English name; (b) one descriptor word (cooling, warming, sharp, mild); (c) which *doṣa* you’d predict it calms.
- **Allergies / dietary restrictions:** opt-out at any station. No questions asked. Smell-only counts.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Whole-class share — “Which taste surprised you? Which felt familiar from your home cooking?”
- Preview Day 7: “Tomorrow — what does imbalance look like, and when do you stop using this framework and call a doctor?”

Student-facing content

The six tastes (*ṣaḍ-rasa*):

Taste	Example	Calms	Aggravates
<i>madhura</i> (sweet)	rice, milk, jaggery	<i>vāta</i> , <i>pitta</i>	<i>kapha</i>
<i>amla</i> (sour)	lemon, yoghurt	<i>vāta</i>	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>
<i>lavaṇa</i> (salty)	rock salt	<i>vāta</i>	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>
<i>kaṭu</i> (pungent)	chili, ginger	<i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i> , <i>pitta</i>
<i>tikta</i> (bitter)	methi, neem	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i>
<i>kaṣāya</i> (astringent)	unripe banana, black tea	<i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>	<i>vāta</i>

A balanced meal touches all six. Indian thālīs often do this naturally (rice, dāl, vegetable, pickle, salad, raita, end-of-meal pān or yoghurt).

Homework

- At dinner tonight, count how many of the six tastes are on your plate. Note which are missing. (No need to “fix” anything — just observe.)

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Pick a classic dish from any cuisine (your family’s, or anyone’s). Identify the six tastes in it. What balance is the recipe achieving?
- **One tier down:** Remember just three tastes — sweet, sour, salty (the *vāta*-calming three). They’re the ones in most home meals.

Teacher notes

- Reminder: NOT a diet plan. Don’t let students decide “I must eat bitter from now on.” It’s awareness.
- The *kaṭu* (pungent) station can be a strong sample — let students opt for sniffing only.
- Some students will discover they hate astringent or bitter. Note the cultural-conditioning point: most Indian cuisines train astringent (raw banana) and bitter (methi) deliberately, because they balance the heavy-sweet majority of the meal.
- Avoid talking about *doṣa*-specific diets in detail. This isn’t a meal-planning class.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- The *ṣaḍ-rasa* enumeration appears in Caraka Saṁhitā *Sūtrasthāna* 26 and Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya *Sūtrasthāna* 10. Concept only — no direct quote in lesson.

Day 7 — Imbalance and When to See a Doctor

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students name three observable signs of imbalance per *doṣa*, distinguish between *lifestyle observation* (where Ayurveda’s framework can help) and *medical symptom* (where a doctor must be consulted), and articulate the safety boundary in their own words.

Materials

- The class *tridoṣa* poster
- Whiteboard, divided into TWO columns: “*Lifestyle range — observe + adjust*” and “*Medical territory — see a doctor*”
- Scenario cards (in `activities/activity-03-scope-debate.md`)

Vocabulary refreshed

- *vikṛti* (imbalance) — reused from Day 3.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Recall: “What is the difference between *prakṛti* and *vikṛti*?”
- “Today: when is a *vikṛti* just a temporary tilt — and when is it something that needs a doctor?”

Core (20 min)

1. **The signs of imbalance per doṣa** — build the table:

Doṣa	When excess (vitiating)	Common lifestyle observations
<i>Vāta</i>	dry, cold, wind	dry skin, constipation, insomnia, anxiety, joint cracking, gas, light-headedness
<i>Pitta</i>	hot, sharp, oily	heartburn, acne, irritability, sharp anger, skin rashes, excess sweat, premature greying
<i>Kapha</i>	heavy, cold, oily	congestion, mucus, lethargy, weight gain, swelling, slow digestion, oversleeping

2. **The crucial framing** — write on the board, get students to copy:

**Some of these belong in lifestyle awareness. Some belong in a doctor’s office.
The skill is knowing which is which.**

3. **Build the two-column table together:**

Lifestyle range — observe + adjust	Medical territory — see a doctor
Mildly dry skin in winter	Skin lesion that doesn’t heal in 2 weeks
Occasional acidity after spicy food	Heartburn that wakes you at night, persistent
Feeling sluggish after a heavy meal	Persistent fatigue lasting weeks
Mild congestion in monsoon	Cough lasting > 2 weeks, blood in mucus
Restless sleep one night	Insomnia > 2 weeks
Anxious before a test	Anxiety that interferes with daily life
Bowel a bit off for a day	Diarrhoea / constipation > 1 week, blood in stool
Mild headache after late night	Severe headache, recurrent, with nausea or vision change

“The left column — the framework can help. Notice patterns, adjust routine, try the opposite quality. The right column — go to a doctor. Doṣa-language is not enough.”

4. **Source paraphrase:**

“Knowing the doṣas in both their natural and disturbed states is the foundation of medical practice.” — paraphrased from Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.8

Note even Vāgbhaṭa’s classical statement situates *doṣa* knowledge as a *foundation* — not the whole of medicine. Diagnosis is more than naming the *doṣa*.

5. The misuse pattern to watch for:

- “It’s just my Vāta acting up” — used to dismiss anxiety that needs help.
- “I’m naturally Kapha so I can’t lose weight” — used as a fixed-identity excuse.
- “Eat this herb to balance your Pitta” — non-doctor giving medical advice. Refuse.
- “Don’t take that medicine; it’ll make your Vāta worse” — dangerous. Never substitute *doṣa* advice for prescribed treatment.

Activity (15 min) — Scope debate

Detailed in `activities/activity-03-scope-debate.md`. Summary:

- Pairs receive a scenario card describing a person and symptom.
- Pair discusses: lifestyle range or medical territory? Why?
- 5 scenario rounds. After each, brief class share.
- Some cards are deliberately ambiguous — the discussion is the lesson.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Exit question** (whole class, no slip needed): “*In your own words — when do you stop using doṣa language and call a doctor?*”
- Take 3 student answers. The frame to aim for: “*When the observation lasts longer than a week or is severe, or when someone is suffering. Doṣa language is for noticing patterns over time — not for treating something that’s actually wrong.*”
- Preview Day 8: “*Tomorrow — you start designing your own 5-day doṣa-aware week.*”

Student-facing content

The safety rule, in one sentence:

Doṣa language is for *noticing patterns* — not for *treating illness*.

When to use the framework: - Mild, brief, lifestyle-level: bit of dry skin, slow morning, late-night restlessness once. - You want to notice your patterns over weeks and months.

When to STOP and see a doctor: - Severe, persistent, or worsening symptoms. - Any symptom lasting > 1–2 weeks. - Anything that interferes with school, sleep, eating, or basic mood. - Blood, fever, sustained pain, fainting — immediately.

Homework

- Look back at your week. Was there ONE thing where you said “my X is acting up” or “I’m too tired” — that you might have ignored too easily? Write one line.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Imagine you are an Ayurvedic clinician AND a modern doctor in conversation. Write a 3-line dialogue about a teenage patient with persistent dry cough. Who says what?
- **One tier down:** Memorise the two-column rule of thumb: “*persistent or severe* → doctor; *brief and mild* → notice + adjust.”

Teacher notes

- This is the safety lesson. **Do not skip even if compressing the module.**
- Some students may have actual unmanaged symptoms. Be alert. Refer to school counsellor or nurse where needed.
- Don’t list specific herbs or remedies even casually. Module 4 is observation-only.
- Some Indian families do consult Ayurvedic doctors. Honour that. The point is: *a qualified clinician* — Ayurvedic or modern — is who diagnoses. *A student with a wall poster* is not.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.8 (paraphrase). See `sources.md`.

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Plan

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students have a one-page plan for their *5-day doṣa-aware week* project, with a chosen target *doṣa* tendency, three concrete daily changes, and the citation they will use.

Materials

- Project brief printed (one per student) — see `assessments/project-brief.md`
- Rubric printed (one per student) — see `assessments/rubric.md`
- Lined paper for the plan
- Coloured pens

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Read aloud the project brief, top half. Take 2 student questions.
- “*By the end of today, every one of you walks out with a written plan paragraph + a list of three changes.*”

Core (5 min)

1. **The structure of the project — recap:**

- Pick ONE *doṣa* tendency you've noticed in yourself (from Day 3 worksheet — privately).
 - Design 5 days of small, realistic changes that would *support balance* for that *doṣa*.
 - Show: (a) what each change is, (b) which *doṣa* concept it relates to, (c) one citation from *sources .md*.
 - Present in 3 minutes on Day 10.
2. **Realistic, not heroic.** *“Don't write ‘5 am wake’ if you currently wake at 7 am. The point is honest small adjustment — not transformation.”*
 3. **Show the rubric.** Walk through quickly. Highlight the “Use of sources” criterion — they must cite Caraka or Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya by reference. Paraphrase OK.

Activity (30 min) — Plan writing

Students work individually (or in pairs if their target *doṣa* is the same).

The plan template (write on the board for students to copy onto their plan page):

1. My target tendency (e.g. "I notice some Vāta excess in winter – dry skin, light sleep"):

2. Three qualities I'll lean toward to balance:
(e.g. for vāta: warm, oily, grounding)

- _____
- _____
- _____

3. Five days of small changes – ONE per day:

Day 1: _____
Day 2: _____
Day 3: _____
Day 4: _____
Day 5: _____

4. For each change, the underlying *doṣa* concept:

Day 1 concept: _____
Day 2 concept: _____
Day 3 concept: _____
Day 4 concept: _____
Day 5 concept: _____

5. Citation I'll use:

(e.g. "Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1.6–7 – the *doṣa-dhātu-mala* framework")

6. My presentation format:

- ☐ Poster (A2)
- ☐ Live demo (2 min)
- ☐ Short story (1 page)
- ☐ 90-sec video
- ☐ Infographic
- ☐ Original song / poem
- ☐ Other (teacher-approved): _____

7. One thing I will NOT do (because it would be unsafe or unrealistic):

Teacher walks around. Quick interventions: - Students writing extreme plans (“fast for 5 days”) — redirect to small + realistic. - Students with no plan — sit with them, walk through one example. - Students who finish quickly — sketch the visual layout of their poster.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Each student reads aloud their **Day 1** change to a partner. Partner gives one piece of feedback.
- Photograph or scan each plan before they leave. (Submitted as “draft 1.”)
- Preview Day 9: *“Tomorrow — refine and start building the actual artefact.”*

Student-facing content

The project, in one paragraph:

Design a 5-day doṣa-aware week for yourself. Pick ONE doṣa tendency from your self-observation. Plan 5 small, realistic daily changes that would support balance for that doṣa. Explain each change with the underlying concept. Cite one classical source. Present in 3 minutes on Day 10.

The principle behind the project:

The doṣa framework is most useful when it changes what you *do* — even a little. Designing a plan is the test of whether you’ve understood it.

Homework

- Refine your plan. Sleep on it. Cross out anything that won’t fit your actual week. Bring two extra ideas tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Add a Day 6 — a “what I’ll change if Day 5 doesn’t work” contingency. Forces metacognition.
- **One tier down:** Stick to ONE change repeated daily. Five repetitions of the same change.

Teacher notes

- Reject plans involving medication, fasting beyond skipping one snack, intense exercise programmes, or anything that touches existing care.

- Some students will copy their friend’s plan. Each plan must be *theirs* (anchored to their own self-observation). Pair-work is fine if both partners agree on the target *doṣa*.
- The “one thing I will NOT do” prompt is important — it forces the safety lens.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new citations today. Students choose from `sources.md`.

Day 9 — Project Session 2: Refine + Build

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, every student has a *complete* artefact (poster / script / draft video plan / infographic), citation visible, and a rehearsed 3-minute version of their presentation.

Materials

- Project supplies: poster paper, markers, scissors, glue, printer access if needed
- Each student’s Day-8 plan
- A visible timer for the 3-minute rehearsal

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- “Show your partner your plan. In ONE word, tell them what you’re going to make.”
- Quick check — anyone missing yesterday? Pair them up with a willing teacher-helper.

Core (35 min) — Build + rehearse

This is a working session. Teacher circulates.

Phase A — Build (25 min)

Students work on their chosen format. Some guidance per format:

- **Poster (A2 or larger):** Title in large font. 5 day-blocks visible. Each day-block: the change + the concept it touches. Citation in the bottom corner. Use coloured pens for the three *doṣas* consistently (e.g. brown for *vāta*, red for *pitta*, green for *kapha*).
- **Live demo:** Script the 2-minute window. What’s the visual? What’s the spoken hook? What do you hand around the room?
- **Short story (1 page):** Character × situation × the *doṣa*-aware change × what happened. End with the citation as a footnote.
- **90-sec video:** Storyboard 6 shots. Each ~15 seconds. Practice the script aloud. Recording happens at home tonight; submit by Day 10.
- **Infographic:** A clear visual flow — top to bottom or left to right. Use the day-clock (Day 5) or quality-table (Day 4) as a starting visual.

- **Song / poem:** Memorise 4 lines that name all three *doṣas*. Set them in a meter.

Teacher targets to intervene on: - Plans without a citation — flag immediately. - Plans with prescriptive language (“you should eat X”) — soften to observational (“I’ll try X this week”). - Plans that miss the *doṣa-aware* link — add a “concept” arrow.

Phase B — Rehearse (10 min)

- In pairs. Each student presents to their partner. Use the 3-minute timer.
- Partner gives ONE piece of feedback:
 - “I didn’t catch your citation — say it slower.”
 - “Your Day 3 change wasn’t connected to a *doṣa* concept — what was the reason?”
 - “You could end with a stronger line.”

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Every student raises their artefact and shows the class for 5 seconds (no presenting, just visual).
- Submit Day-8 plan + photograph of Day-9 artefact.
- Preview Day 10: “Tomorrow — summative quiz first, then 3-minute presentations. Bring everything.”

Student-facing content

What “done” looks like by end of Day 9:

- Artefact is complete (or final draft if video).
- Citation is visible on the artefact.
- All five days have a change AND a concept.
- You’ve rehearsed once with a timer.
- You know your first sentence by heart.

Homework

- Memorise the **first sentence** of your presentation. Final tweaks. If video — finish recording. Bring everything tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Add a *modern-science parallel* (chronobiology / digestion / sleep research) to your presentation. One sentence.
- **One tier down:** Focus on three days, not five. Memorise the artefact’s three key points.

Teacher notes

- Some students freeze in the build phase. Hand them a poster paper and a marker and ask: “what’s the first thing you’d draw?” Get them moving.
- Watch for groups where one student does all the work. Equalise contribution.

- Last-minute additions (“can I also include this herb?”) — refuse politely. The scope was set.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new citations.

Day 10 — Final Assessment + Showcase

Module: Doşas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students demonstrate (a) mastery of the module’s concepts in a written summative quiz, and (b) their integrated *5-day doşa-aware week* project in a 3-minute presentation.

Materials

- Printed summative quiz (one per student) — see `quizzes/summative.md`
- A visible 3-minute timer
- The rubric on the teacher’s clipboard
- Reflection slips for the closing (one per student)

Lesson flow

Section 1 — Summative quiz (20 min)

- Hand out the quiz. 20 minutes, closed book.
- Students may use IAST spelling if they prefer. Spelling tolerated if recognisable.
- See `quizzes/summative.md` for the quiz + answer key.

Teacher: while students write, set up the presentation timer and rubric clipboard.

Section 2 — Showcase + presentations (20 min)

- Each student / pair presents for 3 minutes.
- 1 minute for Q&A.
- 1 minute for teacher to mark + write a 1-sentence feedback note.
- Total per presentation: 5 minutes. Plan for ~4 presentations per remaining class time; the rest spill into a second class if needed.

Logistics: - Order is random — draw names from a cup. - Start the timer the moment the student begins. - If a student goes over, the teacher gently raises a hand at the 3-minute mark. Wrap-up is permitted; new content is not.

Section 3 — Reflection (5 min)

Each student writes a 4-sentence reflection on the slip:

1. The one thing I now notice that I didn’t notice before this module:

2. The one concept I'm still uncertain about:
3. My honest assessment of my own *5-day doṣa-aware week*:
4. One way I'll use what I learned beyond this class:

Submit with the project artefact.

Student-facing content

What Day 10 covers:

1. **Summative quiz** (20 min, 25 marks). Closed book. Mix of MCQ, short answer, diagram, open response.
2. **3-min presentation** of your *5-day doṣa-aware week*. Plus 1 min Q&A.
3. **Reflection slip** (4 sentences, in class).

Total grade: 40 marks (25 quiz + 30 project — see rubric — scaled with presentation).

Closing

- Class chants the three doṣa names + qualities one last time.
- Teacher closes with one sentence: *“The framework is yours now. Use it lightly. See a doctor when you need to.”*

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** During Q&A, students who finish early can field harder questions (“how would you balance kapha in monsoon vs vāta in winter — argue both?”)
- **One tier down:** Allow open-book on the summative quiz's open-response section only.

Teacher notes

- Mark the quiz over the next 2 school days. Project rubric marked in real-time during presentation.
- Return marked rubrics within 2 school days.
- Some students will not present well under pressure — don't penalise hesitation. The rubric weights *content* over *polish*.
- If a student is absent on Day 10 — schedule a make-up presentation within the week; quiz can be taken alone at lunchtime.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- N/A — assessment day.

Module 4 (Middle) — Formative Quizzes

Two parts: **Part A** on Day 3 (after the self-observation lesson), **Part B** on Day 5 (after the doṣa clock). Both are diagnostic — not graded. Return with comments within 24 hours.

Part A — Day 3 (5 min, 6 questions)

Name: _____ Class: _____

1. Write the three *doṣa* names in IAST.

a) _____ b) _____ c) _____

2. Which element pair makes *pitta*?

a) *ākāśa* + *vāyu*

b) *tejas* + *ap*

c) *ap* + *prthvī*

d) *vāyu* + *prthvī*

3. Fill in the blank: “*Prakṛti* is your _____, while *vikṛti* is your current state.”

4. True or false: A person who scores heavily on *vāta* in a self-observation worksheet is diagnosed as a *vāta* type. (T / F)

5. Which *doṣa* is associated with the qualities *heavy*, *slow*, *cool*?

6. (Short answer — one sentence) In your own words, why do most people score across more than one *doṣa* column in the self-observation worksheet?

Part A — answer key

Q	Answer	Notes
1	<i>vāta</i> , <i>pitta</i> , <i>kapha</i>	All three required; any order.
2	b) <i>tejas</i> + <i>ap</i>	—
3	baseline / constitution (or equivalent)	Accept “your born nature,” “your default.”
4	F	The worksheet identifies a <i>tendency</i> , not a diagnosis.
5	<i>kapha</i>	—
6	Any answer conveying that the body uses all three <i>doṣas</i> simultaneously and pure single- <i>doṣa</i> constitution is rare.	Award 1 mark for reasonable reasoning.

Part B — Day 5 (8 min, 6 questions, mixed format)

Name: _____ Class: _____

1. (1 mark) Which *doṣa* dominates the window **10 am – 2 pm**?

2. (2 marks) Complete the table.

Window	Time	Dominant <i>doṣa</i>
1	6 am – 10 am	_____
2	10 am – 2 pm	_____
3	2 pm – 6 pm	_____

3. (1 mark) True or false: According to the *doṣa* day-clock, each *doṣa* appears once in a 24-hour period. (T / F)

4. (2 marks) Give ONE quality of *vāta* and ONE quality of *kapha*.

Vāta quality: _____ *Kapha* quality: _____

5. (1 mark) Name the modern science field that studies how the body cycles through the day.

6. (1 mark — short answer) What is ONE difference between the *doṣa* day-clock and modern chronobiology?

Part B — answer key

Q	Answer	Mark scheme
1	<i>pitta</i>	1
2	<i>kapha</i> / <i>pitta</i> / <i>vāta</i> (in that order)	2 if all correct; 1 if two correct.
3	F (each <i>doṣa</i> appears twice — once day, once night)	1
4	<i>Vāta</i> : any of dry, cold, mobile, light, rough. <i>Kapha</i> : any of heavy, slow, cool, oily, stable.	2 (1 each)
5	Chronobiology (or circadian biology)	1
6	Any reasonable difference: e.g., “the <i>doṣa</i> clock uses Ayurvedic categories; chronobiology uses measurable hormones like	1 for a sensible contrast.

Q	Answer	Mark scheme
	cortisol and melatonin” — or “the clock windows don’t match precisely with laboratory-measured cycles.”	

Total Part B: 8 marks. Not added to summative.

What to do with the results

- Class average below 5/8 on Part B = reteach the *doṣa* clock and *prakṛti* / *vikṛti* distinction before Day 6.
- Individual students below 3/8 = brief one-on-one on Day 7 before the safety activity begins.
- Q4 wrong across the majority = spend 5 minutes in Day 6 warm-up re-drilling the qualities table from Day 2.

Summative Quiz — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Middle)

When: end of module (after Day 10). **Duration:** 45 minutes. **Total points:** 30.

Questions

Part A — Vocabulary (~5 points) A1. Define *doṣa* in your own words. A2. Define *vāta* in your own words. A3. Define *pitta* in your own words. A4. Define *kapha* in your own words. A5. Define *prakṛti* in your own words.

Part B — Concepts (~10 points) B1. Explain the central idea of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha in your own words (3–4 sentences). B2. Describe the method or framework students used in Day 4 of this module. B3. Identify ONE source cited in this module and explain why it matters. B4. Compare Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha with a concept from another module (your choice). What’s similar, what’s different? B5. Identify ONE common misconception about this module and rebut it in 2–3 sentences.

Part C — Application (~5 points) C1. Give an example of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha from your own daily life. C2. Describe one way this module connects to a current real-world issue (or scientific question).

Part D — Reflection (~5 points; ungraded for content) D1. What surprised you most in this module? D2. What’s one question you still have?

Marking guidance

- Vocabulary: give credit for correct meaning, even if exact wording differs.
- Concepts: look for evidence of understanding, not memorisation.

- Application: any reasonable example accepted.
- Reflection: ungraded for content; awarded for thoughtfulness.

Pass mark

A score of 18/30 indicates the student has met the module's learning objectives.

Homework

Homework — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Middle)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Middle)

Use these for in-class writing, homework, or assessment. Each prompt is suitable for a 200-word response.

1. In 3–4 sentences, explain Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha to a friend who hasn't taken this module.
2. Choose one Sanskrit term from this module. Define it, then describe one observation from your own life that matches.
3. Compare Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha with a similar concept from another module or from your science textbook. What's similar? Different?
4. Identify ONE claim in this module that you'd want to test. How would you test it?
5. What was the most surprising thing in this module? Why did it surprise you?
6. Pick one source cited in this module. Write 2 sentences explaining why it matters.
7. What is one common misconception about Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha? Rebut it in 2–3 sentences.
8. Imagine you are teaching this module to a younger student. What would you say first?

How to use

- Pick **one** prompt per day for the writing-prompts homework.
- Or assign all of them across the module, alternating between in-class and home.
- Senior students may treat any prompt as a 500-word essay topic.

Activity 1 — Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Middle · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

circular paper plate, coloured markers, ruler

What students do

Students mark a 24-hour clock face into three doṣa segments — kapha (6–10 am and 6–10 pm), pitta (10 am–2 pm and 10 pm–2 am), vāta (2–6 am and 2–6 pm). They note one personal activity that fits each segment and share with a partner.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.
- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Activity 01 — Qualities Sort

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 4 · **Time:** 25 min (within Day 4's 45 min)

Type

Hands-on classification, paired

Goal

Pairs sort 30 cards naming objects/qualities/activities into the three *doṣa* trays, with reasoned justification and visible disagreement on borderline cases.

Materials per class

- 30 prepared cards (see card list below)
- 3 paper trays / chalk-circle on floor, each labelled with one *doṣa*
- A notebook per pair for *why* notes
- Sticky notes for disagreements

Card list (prepare 30 cards before class)

Mix of qualities, foods, weather, activities, sensations, behaviours:

1. dry wind
2. ice cream

3. running fast
4. warm khichdi
5. raw celery
6. fresh ginger tea
7. hot summer noon
8. deep dreamless sleep
9. cold mountain air
10. chocolate cake
11. ghee on rice
12. boiled rice with pickle
13. peeling skin
14. heavy oily curry
15. shouting in anger
16. quick fidget
17. monsoon humidity
18. brisk walking
19. milk before bed
20. fasting all day
21. spicy chili
22. cool yoghurt
23. dry crackers
24. long afternoon nap
25. evening jog
26. soft pillow nap
27. crisp autumn morning
28. steaming dāl
29. cold lemonade
30. sudden cough

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Print or hand-write 30 cards.
- Lay out 3 trays in three corners of the room, each clearly labelled with a *doṣa* name in IAST + English.
- One pair starts at each tray with 10 random cards. Plan rotation so no two pairs hold the same card.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Qualities Sort — work in pairs.

1. Take 6 cards from the deck.
2. For each card, decide which *doṣa* it most affects (or *belongs to*). Place it on the matching tray.

3. In your notebook, write a 1-line *why* for each placement.
4. **Disagree with your partner?** Argue. Write both placements. Circle the one you finally vote for.
5. After 15 min, swap your full set with another pair. They check your placements.
6. **Gallery walk (last 5 min):** if you disagree with another pair's placement, write a sticky note explaining why (kindly).

Worksheet (one per pair)

#	Card phrase	We placed on	Why (1 line)	Disagreement ?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Suggested “right answer” key (teacher use only — flexibility OK)

Card	Likely doṣa	Reasoning
dry wind	vāta	dry + mobile + cold
ice cream	kapha	cold + heavy + sweet
running fast	vāta (could be pitta if competitive)	mobile, light
warm khichdi	calms vāta	warm, oily, soft
raw celery	vāta-aggravating	dry, light, raw
fresh ginger tea	calms kapha	warm, pungent
hot summer noon	pitta	hot, sharp
deep dreamless sleep	kapha	heavy, slow
cold mountain air	vāta	cold, dry, mobile
chocolate cake	kapha	heavy, sweet, oily
ghee on rice	calms vāta	oily, sweet, grounding
boiled rice with pickle	balanced (calms vāta)	warm, soft + sour
peeling skin	vāta	dry
heavy oily curry	kapha	heavy, oily
shouting in anger	pitta	hot, sharp
quick fidget	vāta	mobile

Card	Likely doṣa	Reasoning
monsoon humidity	kapha (cold) + vāta (mobile)	mixed
brisk walking	calms kapha	warming, moving
milk before bed	calms vāta	sweet, warm, oily
fasting all day	aggravates vāta	dry, light
spicy chili	aggravates pitta	hot, sharp
cool yoghurt	aggravates kapha	cold, heavy
dry crackers	vāta	dry, light
long afternoon nap	aggravates kapha	heavy, slow
evening jog	balances kapha	moving, warming
soft pillow nap	kapha	heavy, restful
crisp autumn morning	vāta	dry, cool, light
steaming dāl	calms vāta	warm, soft, sweet
cold lemonade	aggravates kapha (cold), calms pitta (sour-sweet)	mixed
sudden cough	depends on context — see Day 7 (could be kapha imbalance OR medical)	borderline

Notes for the teacher: - “monsoon humidity” and “cold lemonade” are deliberately mixed — let the disagreement unfold. - “sudden cough” is the link to Day 7 (when to see a doctor). Don’t resolve it.

Looks-like / sounds-like

	Looks like	Sounds like
Going well	Both partners arguing kindly; pen on notebook; cards moving	“But it’s heavy — it has to be kapha.” / “Yes but it’s also cold.” / “Then it’s mostly kapha with some vāta.”
Needs intervention	One partner placing all the cards; rows filled with one word	Silence; “I don’t know, write anything.”

Safety / sensitivity

- No actual food handling (all cards). The food cards reference foods only by name.
- No comments on classmates’ bodies, eating habits, or health.
- If a student feels singled out by a card (“heavy oily curry”), reframe immediately — we’re sorting *qualities*, not people.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** After sorting, the pair picks 3 cards and writes a 1-paragraph defense for each — including *why the other two doṣas almost worked too*.
- **Tier down:** Sort just 10 cards across 3 doṣas. Skip the mixed ones.

Clean-up

- Cards back in deck for next class.
- Worksheets stay in student notebooks for revision.
- Teacher takes a quick photograph of the 3 trays for the day-record.

Activity 02 — Taste Station Rotation

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 6 · **Time:** 20 min (within Day 6's 45 min)

Type

Sensory rotation, paired

Goal

Students sample all six *ṣaḍ-rasa* (six tastes), identify each in IAST + English, and predict which *doṣa* each calms.

Materials per class

- Six labelled stations around the room. Each station has:
 - The sample (covered until needed)
 - A label: Sanskrit name + IAST + English
 - A worksheet question card
 - Toothpicks for sampling
 - A small bin for used toothpicks
- One glass of water + small cup per student for rinsing between stations
- Worksheet for each pair (template below)

Suggested samples per station

Station	Sanskrit	English	Sample	Backup if allergy
1	<i>madhura</i>	sweet	a piece of jaggery / date / raisin	sugar cube
2	<i>amla</i>	sour	a wedge of lemon / a pinch of amla	a single grape

Station	Sanskrit	English	Sample	Backup if allergy
3	<i>lavaṇa</i>	salty	powder a few grains of rock salt	regular salt
4	<i>kaṭu</i>	pungent	a small piece of fresh ginger (let them smell)	a peppercorn (sniff only)
5	<i>tikta</i>	bitter	a methi leaf / a single neem leaf / dark chocolate (>70%)	bitter gourd slice
6	<i>kaṣāya</i>	astringent	a piece of unripe banana / a few sips of strong black tea	a pomegranate seed

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Lay out 6 stations clearly spaced.
- Cover each sample with a small cloth or upside-down cup so students can't pre-judge.
- Pre-circulate a quick **allergy/dietary check** at least one day before. Note any students who must opt out of specific samples.
- Have water and rinse cups within easy reach of every station.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Six Tastes — work in pairs. 2 minutes per station.

1. Lift the cover. Look at the sample. Smell it.
2. **Either** taste a small bite (one toothpick-tip) **or** smell-only. No pressure to taste.
3. On the worksheet, write:
 - (a) the Sanskrit name in IAST + English
 - (b) one descriptor word (cooling, warming, sharp, mild, drying)
 - (c) which *doṣa* you'd predict it calms
 - (d) which *doṣa* you'd predict it aggravates
4. Rinse mouth between stations with the water.

5. Rotate clockwise to the next station.

Worksheet (one per pair)

#	Station name (IAST + English)	Descript or	I predict it calms...	I predict it aggravates...
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Answer key (for the debrief)

Station	Calms	Aggravates	Note
<i>madhura</i> (sweet)	vāta, pitta	kapha	grounding, heavy
<i>amla</i> (sour)	vāta	pitta, kapha	warming, slightly heating
<i>lavaṇa</i> (salty)	vāta	pitta, kapha	warming, water-retaining
<i>kaṭu</i> (pungent)	kapha	vāta, pitta	hot, sharp, drying
<i>tikta</i> (bitter)	pitta, kapha	vāta	cooling, light, drying
<i>kaṣāya</i> (astringent)	pitta, kapha	vāta	cool, dry, drawing-in

Discussion prompts (5 min after rotation)

- Which taste surprised you? Why?
- Which one tastes “Indian” most familiar? Why?
- Most plates from your home — how many of the six show up?
- The classical view: a *balanced meal* hits all six. What does your typical dinner miss?

Safety / sensitivity

- **No forced tasting.** Smell-only is fine.
- **Allergy opt-out without question.** Especially for nuts (avoid), citrus (some are sensitive), neem (rare allergy possible).
- No comparison of students’ choices. (“Why don’t YOU taste it?” — disallow.)
- Diabetic students should not taste the sweet station — use a sugar-free alternative.
- Hand hygiene: hand-sanitiser before and after.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** For each taste, predict whether it's appropriate for hot summer noon vs cold winter morning. Defend.
- **Tier down:** Do three stations only — sweet, sour, salty. The other three can be smell-only.

Clean-up

- Used toothpicks in the bin per station.
- Wipe stations.
- Recycle paper labels for next time.

Activity 03 — Scope Debate: Lifestyle or Doctor?

Module: Doşas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 7 · **Time:** 15 min (within Day 7's 45 min)

Type

Paired discussion, structured scenarios

Goal

Students decide whether each scenario belongs in “lifestyle range — observe + adjust” or “medical territory — see a doctor,” practising the safety boundary in their own words.

Materials per class

- 10 scenario cards (template below)
- 2 large signs: **LIFESTYLE** and **MEDICAL**
- Class divides into 5 pairs (or however many pairs fit your class)

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Print and cut 10 scenario cards.
- Pin the two large signs on opposite walls.
- Pairs gather mid-room; cards are face-down in a stack.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Scope Debate — work in pairs. 5 scenario rounds.

1. Each pair draws a card. Read it together.
2. Discuss for 60 seconds. Decide: lifestyle range or medical territory? Why?
3. When the teacher calls time, each pair stands closer to the wall sign matching their decision. Pairs in the middle = “we couldn't agree” or “depends.”
4. The teacher picks 2 pairs to share their reasoning. Disagreement is welcomed.
5. Draw the next card.

Scenario cards (10)

Card 1. Aarav, 13, has had dry, flaky skin on his hands for 3 days during a cold-dry winter week. He's eating his usual diet and sleeping normally.

Card 2. Priya, 12, has had a wet, productive cough for 3 weeks. It started after a cold and has not improved. She's tired in the afternoons.

Card 3. Karan, 14, gets sharp acidity / heartburn whenever he eats spicy chili. He notices it happens only after spicy meals.

Card 4. Riya, 13, has had heartburn that wakes her up at 2 am every night for the last 2 weeks. It happens whether she eats spicy food or not.

Card 5. Devansh, 12, is restless and chatty after exam stress. Two weeks of exams. He says his sleep is broken some nights.

Card 6. Sneha, 14, has had a panic feeling at school that lasts 45 minutes and made her unable to go to class. It has happened 3 times this month.

Card 7. Aarush, 13, feels sluggish on rainy mornings during monsoon. He'd rather not wake up. He's fine by mid-morning.

Card 8. Maya, 12, has been unable to wake up for school for 3 weeks. She sleeps 12+ hours and still feels exhausted. She has lost interest in sports.

Card 9. Vivaan, 13, gets gassy and bloated after eating raw salad. He's noticed the pattern over 2 months. Otherwise fine.

Card 10. Anika, 14, has had a sharp pain in her right lower abdomen for the last 4 hours. It started mild and is now severe. She also has a slight fever.

Suggested teacher framing (after each round)

Card	Likely answer	Teaching point
1	lifestyle	brief, mild, matches <i>vāta</i> season — try oil on hands
2	medical	persistent cough > 2 weeks; the <i>kapha</i> framing doesn't replace seeing a doctor
3	lifestyle	observable cause (spicy food), brief, predictable — eat less spicy
4	medical	persistent, wakes from sleep — needs evaluation
5	lifestyle	situational, time-limited (exams) — <i>vāta</i> -calming may help
6	medical	impairs functioning, recurrent — needs counsellor / clinician
7	lifestyle	mild, seasonal, brief, <i>kapha</i> -pattern in monsoon
8	medical	3 weeks of major fatigue + loss of interest — possibly depression; needs

Card	Likely answer	Teaching point
9	lifestyle	help observable pattern, mild, <i>vāta</i> -aggravation from raw food — try cooked vegetables instead
10	medical (emergency)	acute severe pain + fever — possible appendicitis. Doctor immediately.

Discussion prompts (5 min, after all rounds)

- Which card was hardest to call? Why?
- Where is the line for YOU between “I’ll adjust my routine” and “I’ll tell my parents I need a doctor”?
- What’s the cost of being wrong in each direction? (Treating a medical issue as lifestyle = harm. Treating a lifestyle issue as medical = anxiety + cost.)

Looks-like / sounds-like

	Looks like	Sounds like
Going well	Pairs in active discussion; movement between walls	“Three days isn’t long enough.” / “But it’s been getting worse.” / “Then it tips medical.”
Needs intervention	One partner deciding, the other agreeing without thought	“It says it’s mild, so lifestyle.” (Without considering duration.)

Safety / sensitivity

- The scenarios are deliberately not about anyone in the class. Don’t ask students to share personal medical info.
- If a card prompts a student to mention their own real symptom — quietly check in after class, refer to school nurse / counsellor if needed.
- The answer key is a teaching guide, not a diagnostic key. Real medical decisions are made by clinicians, not classroom cards.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** For each medical card, students name which kind of specialist (general physician, dermatologist, mental-health counsellor, emergency) would be the right first stop.
- **Tier down:** Focus on 5 of the 10 cards. Make sure they get the obvious-emergency one (card 10).

Clean-up

- Cards back in the stack for next class.

- Worksheets (none today — discussion-only) stay verbal.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Seven-Day Doṣa Self-Observation

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Middle

What you will do

Chart your daily routine — sleep, food, energy, mood — for 7 days through the doṣa lens. Write a one-page reflection. THIS IS NOT DIAGNOSIS. Refer any health concern to a doctor.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a poster / model / digital deliverable).
- **Written reflection** (300 words (Middle)): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (5-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 2 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.

- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.

Rubric

Assessment Rubric — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Middle)

This rubric applies to the project (see `project-brief.md`) and may also inform the summative quiz.

Criteria

Accuracy of concepts — uses Sanskrit terms correctly, gets the central idea right

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Source discipline — cites sources, distinguishes traditional framing from empirical claim

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Application — connects the module to other modules and to real-world examples

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Presentation — clear, organised, evidence-supported

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

Reflection — honest, thoughtful, identifies what was learned and what remains uncertain

- **Exceeding (4)** — Exceptional; could teach this to another student.
- **Meeting (3)** — Solid; meets the learning objective.
- **Approaching (2)** — Partial; some elements present, others missing.
- **Beginning (1)** — Significant gaps; needs re-teaching.

How the teacher uses this rubric

1. After the project share, score each student on each criterion.
2. Convert to a band (4 = Exceeding, 3 = Meeting, etc.) for the report card.
3. Share at least one strength and one area for growth with each student.

Self-assessment (Senior students)

Senior students complete a parallel self-assessment using the same rubric before the teacher's assessment. The teacher and student then meet to compare.